

Care Circle

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Why We Built Care Circle

The Vision: Healthcare at the Interface with Others

Healthcare is personal, but never solitary. When someone faces a health challenge, their circle of loved ones faces it alongside them. Yet healthcare systems isolate patients behind privacy walls that make it nearly impossible to share with the people who need to know.

What our users showed us: Even before Care Circle existed, **30% of all Ditto summaries were being shared** with family via WhatsApp and Signal. People were already building care circles—we just weren't helping them do it effectively.

The Problem

Current solutions fail at the interface where your care touches others:

- **Epic/MyChart:** Complex proxy access, clinical-only, no mobile design
- **WhatsApp:** Health updates lost between grocery lists, no privacy controls
- **Existing platforms:** Either too clinical (portals) or too social (messaging), missing the healthcare context

When healthcare journeys become serious, people share with **up to 100 people**—family, friends, colleagues, caregivers. This isn't oversharing; it's how humans navigate health challenges.

The Business Case

Network Effects & Flywheel:

- Each patient invitation brings new users into Ditto
- Followers become future patients who need to share their own care
- Natural viral loop: patients → loved ones → future patients
- Transforms Ditto from single-user tool to network platform

Validated Demand:

- Consistent user requests for exactly this feature
 - Investors identified Care Circle as key differentiator and growth driver
 - 30% organic sharing behavior proves product-market fit
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How It Works

Overview

Care Circle creates a "Polarsteps for healthcare" where followers stay informed about a patient's medical journey through clear, curated updates.

Core Flow:

1. Patient generates summaries in Ditto (recording, imports, or manual)
2. Patient shares specific events with their circle via invite links
3. Followers receive notifications and view updates in their Ditto app
4. Patient maintains full control with granular privacy settings

Features in Scope

Detailed functional requirements: [Functional Scoping](#)

v1 Core Features (November 2025 Release):

- **Summary Sharing:** Share complete summaries with optional section exclusions
- **Invite Links:** One-tap sharing via WhatsApp, Signal, email
- **Follow Requests:** All requests require approval
- **Privacy Controls:** Per-event sharing, follower removal, individual event privacy
- **Notifications:** Follow requests, acceptances, new event shares

- **Security:** End-to-end encryption, EU data residency

v2 Roadmap:

- Granular follower groups (different access for different relationships)
 - Search within Ditto for existing users
 - Event engagement (reactions, comments)
 - Link management controls and custom expiration
 - Auto-share settings for specific individuals
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Forward-Looking Strategy

Doubling Down on the Interface

Care Circle represents our strategic commitment to **the interface where your care touches others**—whether formal caregivers, practical helpers, or emotional support. This field is fundamentally underserved by existing healthcare technology.

Why This Matters:

Healthcare happens in context. A diagnosis isn't just medical data—it's something that affects your partner's schedule, your kids' understanding, your parent's worry, your friend's ability to help. Current systems ignore this reality.

Our Differentiation:

We're building at the intersection of:

- **Clinical clarity** (what the doctor actually said)
- **Social support** (who needs to know and how to help)
- **Practical coordination** (what happens next and who does what)

No existing solution effectively serves this space. Care portals focus only on clinical. Social platforms lack healthcare context. Care coordination tools assume professional caregivers only.

Future Innovation: Visualizing Healthcare Journeys

The Vision:

In the future, Ditto will transform how we visualize healthcare journeys, making it intuitive for both patients and their circles to understand:

- Where you are in your care journey
- What's happening now and what comes next

- How different threads of care connect
- Where others can meaningfully contribute

Inspired by Travel, Built for Care:

Just as Polarsteps made travel journeys shareable and engaging, Ditto will make healthcare journeys comprehensible and collaborative. Not gamified or trivialized—but human, visual, and accessible.

The Opportunity:

When your circle can see and understand your journey, they can:

- Offer help at the right moments
- Ask informed questions
- Reduce misunderstandings and family stress
- Provide meaningful emotional support
- Coordinate practical assistance

This creates value for both traveler and followers—patients get better support, loved ones feel connected rather than helpless.

Questions & Answers

For Patients

Q: Who controls my health information?

You do, completely. Only people you explicitly invite and approve can see anything. You control what to share event-by-event, and you can revoke access anytime.

Q: What if I change my mind?

Make any event private to remove it from followers' view, or remove followers entirely to revoke all access.

Q: Do followers need the Ditto app?

Yes, to ensure end-to-end encryption and privacy controls. Invite links guide them to download.

For Loved Ones

Q: How do I start following someone?

They send you an invite link. Click it, download Ditto if needed, and approve the request.

Q: What will I see?

Only what the patient chooses to share—summaries, updates, events they want you to know about.

Q: Will I get notified?

Yes, push notifications when someone shares new events. Customize in settings.

For Healthcare Professionals

Q: How does this help my patients?

Reduces burden of repetitive explanations. Family arrives informed, asks better questions, provides better support. Often improves adherence and outcomes.

Q: Privacy or liability concerns?

No. Patients control all sharing—similar to verbal family discussions but more organized. You're not responsible for what patients share with their families.

For Investors

Q: What makes this defensible?

Network effects. Each invitation brings new users who become future patients. Care circle data and relationships create switching costs.

Q: Growth mechanics?

Viral loop: patients invite 2-5 loved ones → loved ones need the app → become engaged users → eventually share their own care. 30% were already sharing—we're making it native.

Q: Market opportunity?

Everyone faces healthcare. Serious journeys involve 10-100 people. In US alone, 65% of adults manage chronic conditions. Each could have a care circle.

Q: Monetization path?

Multiple options: freemium (advanced features), B2B2C (health systems), employer benefits. Always privacy-first—no ads, no data sales.

Narratives & Positioning**Full press release and positioning materials:**

[Narratives and Positioning](#)

Core Message

"Healthcare Was Never Meant to Be Lonely"

We broke healthcare by making it too private. Built systems so locked down you can't share with the people you love. A health journey you're supposed to navigate alone.

But that's not how it actually works. Our users showed us: 30% of summaries were already being shared via WhatsApp. They were building care circles. We just weren't helping them do it.

Key Narratives by Audience

Investors: Network platform transformation with compounding growth

Patients: Keep your circle informed, on your terms, with one tap

Loved Ones: Stay connected to what matters—informed, not guessing

Healthcare Professionals: Empowered patients with stronger support systems lead to better outcomes

Competitive Positioning

Complete competitive analyses:

- [CareCircle & Care Giver Solutions](#)
- [CaringBridge Analysis](#)
- [Carenzorgt Analysis](#)

Competitive Landscape Summary

Solution	Strength	Where Ditto Wins
WhatsApp/Signal	Universal, familiar	Organization, privacy controls, healthcare context, permanence
Epic MyChart	Direct EHR connection	Ease of sharing, multiple recipients, clarity, mobile-first
CaringBridge	Trusted platform, social support	AI clarity, granular privacy, clinical data, EU standards
Carenzorgt	Deep EHR integration (Nedap), GGZ market leader	Consumer-first design, clarity over clinical

		access, network effects
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Our Position

Ditto is the **clarity and coordination layer** for healthcare. We serve the underserved space where clinical care meets social support—translating medical complexity while enabling meaningful involvement from your circle.

Key Differentiators:

1. AI-powered clarity (capture, transcribe, explain)
2. Granular per-event privacy controls
3. Mobile-first consumer design
4. End-to-end encryption with EU data residency
5. Built for the interface where care touches others

Inspiration: Polarsteps for Healthcare

Why Polarsteps Matters:

Polarsteps transformed how people share travel journeys. It proved that complex, ongoing experiences can be:

- **Visualized intuitively** (maps and timelines that make sense at a glance)
- **Made engaging** (followers genuinely care and stay involved)
- **Valuable for both sides** (travelers enjoy sharing, followers feel connected)
- **Easy to contribute to** (simple to add updates, simple to follow)

What We're Learning:

The success of Polarsteps demonstrates that people want to share journeys, and others want to follow them—when the experience is designed well. Healthcare is a more serious journey, but the same principles apply:

- **Visualization over text dumps:** Show the journey, don't just describe it
- **Progressive disclosure:** Surface what matters, details when needed
- **Natural sharing moments:** Make updates feel relevant, not obligatory
- **Value for followers:** Give them meaningful ways to engage and help

Our Opportunity:

If Polarsteps made "where are you?" visible and shareable, Ditto can make "how are you?" equally clear. Not by gamifying health, but by making complex medical journeys comprehensible and collaborative.

This is the future we're building: healthcare journeys that make sense to everyone who needs to understand them.

Development Process

Complete development and testing documentation:

[CC - The Road to Production](#)

Timeline: September – November 2025

September – Early October: Discovery & Design

- 3-4 weeks of user research with super users and new users
- Validated 30% organic sharing behavior
- Extensive UX design and iteration
- [Research Plan](#)

October: Technical Development

- Backend: Care Circle service, encryption, invite system
- Mobile: iOS and Android implementations
- [Care Circle Service Documentation](#)

October – November: Testing & Refinement

- Functional, security, and performance testing
- Team testathon (Nov 10) and mini-testathon (Nov 12)
- Code freeze November 15

November 16: Production Release

- Soft launch to all users
- Real-time monitoring and early feedback collection
- Iterative improvements based on usage data

Key Resources

Technical:

- [GitHub Repository](#)

- [API Documentation](#)
- [OpenAPI Specs](#)

Process:

- [Testing & Production Checklist](#)
 - [Functional Scoping](#)
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